

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/43: Central question and the 3-1-infinity route

CENTRAL QUESTION: WHAT CAN REASON KNOW WITH NECESSITY, AND WHAT IS THERE TO KNOW

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+--> WARRANT, not hostility to the senses: experience may OCCASION a
| thought; only intellect certifies NECESSITY and UNIVERSALITY
+--> NECESSARY = could not be otherwise | UNIVERSAL = all cases, not
| all observed cases | A PRIORI = justified independently of any
| particular experience
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THE TEST ALL THREE INHERIT - WHAT IS A SUBSTANCE?

"that which is in itself and is conceived through itself,
needing nothing else in order to exist"

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HOW STRICTLY IS "NEEDING NOTHING ELSE" ENFORCED?

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+-----+-----+-----+			
DESCARTES	SPINOZA	LEIBNIZ	
loosely/analogically	strictly	strictly + SIMPLICITY	
THREE substances	ONE substance	INFINITELY MANY monads	
God + res cogitans	God, or Nature	simple, unextended,	
+ res extensa	(Deus sive Natura)	perceiving, striving	
DUALISM	MONISM / PANTHEISM	PLURALISM	
INTERACTION (pineal)	PARALLELISM	PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY	
God GUARANTEES	God IS the system	God SELECTS+HARMONISES	
libertarian will	adequate self-	spontaneity+intelligence	
	determination	+contingency	
+-----+-----+-----+			

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+--> COST TO DESCARTES: interaction is unintelligible
+--> COST TO SPINOZA: individuality and alternatives are lost
+--> COST TO LEIBNIZ: correspondence must be bought from God in advance

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MNEMONICS: substance "3 -> 1 -> infinity" | mind-body "I-P-H" (Interaction,
Parallelism, Harmony) | God "G-I-S" (Guarantees, Is, Selects)

SYLLABUS (verbatim): "Rationalism (Descartes, Spinoza, Leibniz); Cartesian
Method and Certain Knowledge; Substance; God; Mind-Body Dualism;
Determinism and Freedom." Paper I, Section A, item 2.

CORPUS SIGNAL: 14 primary-owned parts of 112 Western parts, 2018-2025;
joint-highest in Western Philosophy; 2021 is the only year with none.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/43: Chronology and textual map that prevents anachronism

1596-1650 RENE DESCARTES

1637 Discourse on the Method (French) -> four rules; je pense, donc je suis

1641 Meditations on First Philosophy (Latin; French 1647)

I -> senses, dream argument, evil genius (genius malignus)

II -> "I am, I exist"; the wax; mind better known than body

III -> trademark/causal proof; conservation proof; kinds of idea

IV -> error: the infinite will outruns the finite intellect

V -> the ontological proof

VI -> the real distinction; the external world

1641 Objections and Replies -> ARNAULD states the Circle (Fourth Objections)

1643 Correspondence with PRINCESS ELISABETH OF BOHEMIA -> interaction gap

1644 Principles of Philosophy -> I.7 cogito ergo sum; I.51 "substance" is
conceded to be ANALOGICAL

1649 Passions of the Soul -> pineal gland; the mind-body union

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1632-1677 BENEDICT DE SPINOZA (reads Descartes; refuses the softening)

1656 excommunicated from the Amsterdam Jewish community (heterodoxy)

1663 Descartes' Principles of Philosophy, set out geometrically

1670 Theological-Political Treatise (anonymous)

1674 LETTER 50 to Jarig Jelles, 2 June -> "determination is negation"

1677 Ethics (posthumous), demonstrated more geometrico

I -> substance, God or Nature, necessity, immanent cause

II -> attributes, modes, parallelism, three kinds of knowledge

III -> striving (conatus) and the affects

IV -> human bondage; Deus sive Natura in the Preface

V -> freedom, intuitive knowledge, intellectual love of God

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1646-1716 GOTTFRIED WILHELM LEIBNIZ (reads both; refuses one substance)

1686 Discourse on Metaphysics -> the complete individual concept

1704 New Essays on Human Understanding (against Locke; published 1765)

1710 Theodicy -> le meilleur des mondes possibles

1714 Monadology (French; printed 1720/1840) -> Sec.7 "no windows"

1715-16 Leibniz-Clarke correspondence -> sufficient reason; indiscernibles

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1759 VOLTAIRE, Candide -> satirises "the best of all possible worlds"

CAUTION: reception, NOT doctrine. Never cite Candide as Leibniz's view.

CONSEQUENCE: the order is CAUSAL, not merely chronological. Spinoza's monism corrects an equivocation Descartes CONCEDES in Principles I.51; Leibniz's pluralism corrects Spinoza's absorption of individuals.

CAUTION 1: the Ethics appeared only after Spinoza's death, so seventeenth-century reaction to "Spinozism" often ran ahead of the text.

CAUTION 2: Leibniz's system must be assembled from the Discourse, the Theodicy, the Monadology and the correspondence together - which matters whenever an examiner quotes a single work.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/43: Five tenets and the definition that splits the school

THE FIVE TENETS THAT DEFINE THE SCHOOL [2025 Q2(a), first limb]

1	INNATE COGNITIVE RESOURCES	native CAPACITIES or structures of intellect, NOT copies taken from sense -> say "dispositional", never "known at birth", or Locke wins immediately
2	REASON GROUNDS NECESSITY	experience OCCASIONS; intellect WARRANTS
3	INTUITION AND DEDUCTION	Descartes: clear intuition + ordered deduction Spinoza: geometrical order (more geometrico) Leibniz: identities, sufficient reasons, complete concepts
4	THE REAL IS THE RATIONAL	reality has an intelligible structure
5	SUBSTANCE METAPHYSICS	explain by substance, attribute, mode

NOT THE CLAIM: that sensory beliefs are uniformly false, that the senses are useless, or that every truth is consciously present at birth.

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TENET 5 CARRIES THE INHERITED DEFINITION, AND THE DEFINITION HAS A DIAL

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DESCARTES turns it DOWN (Principles I.51)	only God needs NOTHING WHATEVER; mind and matter need only God -> "created substances"
SPINOZA turns it to MAXIMUM	conceived through itself = depends on nothing at all -> only the infinite qualifies -> ONE
LEIBNIZ keeps plurality, ADDS SIMPLICITY	extended = divisible = composite = not ultimate -> partless units -> INFINITELY MANY

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MEMORY CHAIN: ATTRIBUTE SEPARATES -> INDEPENDENCE UNIFIES -> SIMPLICITY MULTIPLIES.

MECHANISM FOR 2018 Q2(a): a method fixes HOW to argue; it does not fix WHICH criterion of "ontologically basic" to enforce, nor how strictly. The divergence is rationalism operating CONSISTENTLY, not one of them lapsing.

HONEST LIMIT: the school supplies deductive ambition and vocabulary but no neutral procedure for choosing among the three criteria.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/43: Descartes: the four rules and the three-stage doubt

THE FOUR RULES (Discourse on the Method, Part II, 1637)

- 1 EVIDENCE accept nothing as true which is not clearly and evidently known to be so; avoid haste and prejudice
- 2 ANALYSIS divide each difficulty into as many parts as its solution requires
- 3 ORDER conduct thoughts in order, from the simplest and easiest upward to the more complex
- 4 ENUMERATION make enumerations so complete and reviews so general that nothing is omitted

| RULE 1 IS THE ENGINE. Rules 2-4 are intellectual hygiene borrowed
| from mathematical practice and by themselves remove no belief.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/43: Descartes: the four rules and the three-stage doubt (continued)

CLASS-BY-CLASS DEMOLITION (Meditation I) - CUMULATIVE, IN THIS ORDER

STAGE	ARGUMENT	WHAT SURVIVES IT
1 SENSE-DECEPTION	the senses have deceived before - a bent stick in water, a distant tower - and what deceives once is imprudent to trust	apparently my immediate situation: this hand, this paper
2 DREAM ARGUMENT	there is no certain mark distinguishing waking from sleep -> the whole external world may be absent	the simple and universal: extension, shape, quantity, number; MATHEMATICS
3 EVIL GENIUS (genius malignus)	suppose a supremely powerful malicious deceiver bends all his effort to deceiving me - even about $2 + 3 = 5$	only what cannot be false WHILE I AM THINKING IT

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THE LADDER BREAKS UNDER ITS OWN WEIGHT: TO BE DECEIVED, I MUST EXIST TO BE DECEIVED.

CHARACTER OF THE DOUBT: METHODIC (adopted as a procedure) · HYPERBOLIC (pushed further than ordinary life warrants) · PROVISIONAL (Descartes does not believe the world is absent).

TRAP: reporting the three doubts unordered destroys the escalation, which is itself the argument.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/43: The thinking self: wording, status and limits

THE TWO FORMULATIONS - DO NOT CONFUSE THEM

Discourse (1637, French) je pense, donc je suis

Principles I.7 (1644, Latin) cogito, ergo sum

MEDITATIONS II (1641) "I am, I exist, is necessarily true whenever
 it is put forward by me or conceived in my
 mind"

TRAP: do NOT attribute "cogito, ergo sum" to the Meditations.

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STATUS

+--> IMMEDIATE INTUITION of the mind, NOT a syllogism. Descartes expressly
| denies a suppressed major premise such as "whatever thinks exists".

+--> PERFORMATIVE and PRESENT-TENSE: the act of entertaining the doubt
| certifies the doubter at that moment.

+--> DEFEATS THE DECEIVER BY USING HIM: let him deceive as much as he can,
| he can never make me nothing so long as I think I am something.

+--> THE ARCHIMEDEAN POINT: one firm and immovable point sufficient to
move the earth.

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WHAT IT ESTABLISHES

thinking is occurring

the thinker exists

WHILE thinking

one proposition immune

to the evil genius

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WHAT IT DOES NOT YET ESTABLISH

an enduring immaterial substance

diachronic personal identity

that the thinker is ONLY a thinking thing

(the real distinction is argued in

Meditation VI, not here)

DESCARTES THEN DEVELOPS THE THINKING THING (res cogitans) THROUGH THE REST
OF MEDITATION II: "a thing that doubts, understands, affirms, denies, is
willing, is unwilling, and also imagines and has sensory perceptions".

LATER PRESSURE: Lichtenberg - Descartes was entitled only to "there is
thinking"; Hume - the self is a bundle, not a substance.

WHY THIS IS A RATIONALIST FOUNDATION: reached with NO sensory premise;
grasped by INTELLECTUAL INTUITION; and it supplies the MODEL from which
the criterion of truth is read off.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/43: Clear and distinct perception; three kinds of ideas

STEP 1 READ THE CRITERION OFF THE MODEL - IT IS DERIVED, NOT ASSUMED

Why was "I am, I exist" certain? Because it was perceived CLEARLY and DISTINCTLY. RULE: whatever I perceive very clearly and distinctly is true.

CLEAR = present and open to an attentive mind

DISTINCT = so sharply separated from everything else that it contains within itself only what is clear

NOTE FOR PANEL 12: the rule is extracted from ONE instance. Turning it into a GENERAL licence for perceptions no longer attended to is exactly the work God is later asked to do - which is where the Circle strikes.

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STEP 2 SORT THE CONTENTS OF THE MIND (Meditation III)

KIND	LATIN	HOW IT ARISES	EXAMPLES
ADVENTITIOUS	adventitiae	seem to come from outside, INVOLUNTARILY; passive	heat, colour, the sound of a passing cart
FACTITIOUS	factitiae	constructed BY ME from other ideas; voluntary	a golden mountain, a siren, a unicorn
INNATE	innatae	NATIVE to the mind's rational nature; ELICITED, not copied	thought, God, infinity, substance, the axioms of maths

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TECHNICAL VOCABULARY REQUIRED FOR PANEL 11

OBJECTIVE REALITY of an idea = how much reality it REPRESENTS

FORMAL REALITY of a thing = how much reality it HAS

CAUSAL ADEQUACY PRINCIPLE = the cause of an idea must have at least as much formal reality as the idea has objective reality

PURPOSE OF THE CLASSIFICATION: it exists so that the idea of GOD can be placed in the third class and its content argued to exceed anything a finite mind could have manufactured.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/43: Innate ideas: the argument from insufficiency

THE ARGUMENT FROM INSUFFICIENCY - PRESENT INNATENESS AS A CONCLUSION,
NEVER AS AN ASSERTION

- 1 Some ideas have a content - an OBJECTIVE REALITY - that no finite, changing sensation could supply.
- 2 THE INFINITE is the clearest case: it cannot be built by extending or negating the finite, because I recognise myself as finite only BY CONTRAST with an already-possessed idea of the infinite.
- 3 SUBSTANCE - a bearer persisting through changing qualities - is delivered by no sense-organ (the wax argument, Panels 9-10, shows this directly).
- 4 MATHEMATICAL NECESSITY cannot be read off any number of measured figures, because measurement yields "so far" and never "must".
- 5 THEREFORE these ideas are native to the intellect's own constitution.

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INNATENESS, STATED AT ITS STRONGEST [this is the 2023 Q2(c) hinge]

NOT: an explicitly entertained proposition present in an infant's consciousness <- the OCCURRENT version; Locke destroys it

BUT: a DISPOSITION or native capacity, activated on an appropriate occasion - the mind carries "SEEDS OF KNOWLEDGE" which experience may prompt but does not create

DESCARTES' OWN ANALOGY (Comments on a Certain Broadsheet): we say a family has an inherited disposition to a disease, not because the infant suffers it in the womb, but because the constitution is such that the condition will develop.

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INNATENESS IS A CONSTITUTION, NOT A CONTENT.

WHERE EACH INNATE IDEA IS USED LATER

- idea of GOD -> the trademark proof (Panel 11)
- idea of EXTENSION -> the wax argument (Panels 9-10)
- idea of SUBSTANCE -> the whole substance metaphysics (Panel 14)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/43: Locke's grounds, the replies and the adjudication

LOCKE, ESSAY CONCERNING HUMAN UNDERSTANDING, BOOK I

The mind is "white paper, void of all characters", furnished from
SENSATION and REFLECTION.

TRAP: omitting REFLECTION misstates Locke. His two sources are sense AND
the mind's observation of its own operations.

LOCKE'S OBJECTION	CARTESIAN REPLY	WHAT STILL STANDS
NO UNIVERSAL ASSENT children and those lacking the concepts do not affirm the alleged principles	innateness is DISPOSI- TIONAL, not continuous conscious assent; universal assent was never the claim	a disposition must be specified so narrowly that not EVERY learnable truth counts as innate <- sharpest
NOTHING UNKNOWN CAN BE "IN THE MIND" if mental content is transparent, every knowable truth is "innate"	native capacities operate before reflective recognition; structure is not the same as occurrent content	the reply risks shifting from INNATE IDEAS to an uncontroversial CAPACITY TO LEARN, which is no
SENSATION AND REFLECTION SUFFICE all materials of ideas trace to experience	finite experience cannot by itself yield the POSITIVE idea of infinity or the WARRANT for mathematical necessity	Locke reconstructs infinity by repetition and negation, necessity by abstraction

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ADJUDICATION THAT EARNS THE MARK

Locke DECISIVELY refutes OCCURRENT innatism - the doctrine that the mind is
born consciously holding propositions.

He does NOT as clearly refute DISPOSITIONAL innatism.

But the burden then shifts to the rationalist to say what makes a
disposition specifically INNATE rather than a general capacity to learn -
and at that point the debate is genuinely unresolved.

ANSWER RULE: never defend the caricature. State the dispositional version
FIRST, then let Locke attack, then rule.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/43: The wax argument: the eight numbered steps

- 1 TAKE THE CLEAREST POSSIBLE CASE OF A BODY - wax fresh from the honeycomb
 SENSIBLE CATALOGUE: taste of honey | scent of flowers | a colour |
 a shape | a size | hardness | coldness | a sound when rapped
 |
- 2 MOVE IT TO THE FIRE -> EVERY item in that catalogue is destroyed or
 replaced: taste and scent vanish, colour alters, shape and size are lost,
 it becomes liquid and hot, and it no longer sounds
 |
- 3 YET I JUDGE, WITHOUT THE LEAST HESITATION, THAT THE SAME WAX REMAINS
 |
- 4 THEREFORE what I take the wax to BE is not identical with any item at
 step 1, since all of them were replaced while the wax persisted
 |
- 5 NOR IS IT DELIVERED BY IMAGINATION: heat can give the wax an INDEFINITE
 number of shapes and sizes, and I cannot run through indefinitely many
 images. THIS IS THE FORCE OF *flexibile et mutabile* ("flexible and
 changeable").
 |
- 6 THEREFORE the wax is grasped as an EXTENDED, FLEXIBLE, CHANGEABLE thing by
 the INTELLECT ALONE - by *inspectio mentis*, rendered "purely mental
 scrutiny" in the Cottingham-Stoothoff-Murdoch translation and "inspection
 of the mind" in Haldane-Ross
 |
- 7 FURTHER: at every stage - judging the wax present, doubting it, being
 deceived about it - I perceive MYSELF judging. Each perception of a body is
 ipso facto a perception of the mind that perceives, and a MORE CERTAIN one,
 because it survives even if the body does not exist
 |
- 8 THEREFORE (a) BODIES ARE KNOWN BY UNDERSTANDING, NOT BY SENSE
 (b) THE MIND IS *notior* - MORE EVIDENTLY KNOWN - THAN ANY BODY

PAIRED CASE IN THE SAME MEDITATION: "HATS AND COATS". From a window I say I
SEE men crossing the square; strictly I see only hats and coats and JUDGE
that men are underneath. What passes for seeing is in fact judging.

PRINTED SUB-TITLE OF MEDITATION II: "The nature of the human mind, and how it
is better known than the body."

EXACT SUBTERMS TO USE: *cera* | *inspectio mentis* | *sensus* vs *imaginatio* vs
intellectus | *flexibile et mutabile* | *res extensa*.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/43: The wax: presuppositions, objections and verdict

WHAT THE ARGUMENT ASSUMES - STATE THESE; THE 15/20-MARK MARKS ARE HERE

- P1 SUBSTANCE/ATTRIBUTE METAPHYSICS IS ALREADY IN PLACE. Identity through TOTAL qualitative replacement requires a BEARER distinct from the qualities. Step 3 therefore uses the very metaphysics the Meditations claim to derive.
- P2 SENSE IS EXHAUSTED BY THE CATALOGUE. If sense could deliver a structural or relational item - not just colour, taste, sound - then step 4 fails.
- P3 IMAGINATION IS IMAGE-BOUND and therefore finite in range, while intellect is not.
- P4 PERCEPTION IS SELF-INTIMATING. I cannot perceive without perceiving

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/43: The wax: presuppositions, objections and verdict (continued)

THAT I perceive. Step 7 depends wholly on this.

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OBJECTION	SOURCE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
what survives melting is just "extended stuff", an ABSTRACTION built from repeated sense-experience	GASSENDI, Fifth Objections; the empiricist line	the abstraction must still be OF something identical across the change, and no sensory item registers IDENTITY. RESIDUAL: the CONCEPT is not an image; the KNOWLEDGE is not thereby shown a priori
strip away every sensible quality and nothing remains; extension without sensible qualities is unintelligible	BERKELEY, Principles Sec.9-11	extension is not a further quality but the MODE OF BEING of every sensible quality. RESIDUAL: the reply presupposes exactly what Berkeley denies
step 7 confuses CERTAINTY with CONTENT	analytic reconstruction	Descartes needs only EPISTEMIC priority for the order of the Meditations. RESIDUAL: fair - "better known" must be read strictly as MORE INDUBITABLE

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WHAT IS AND IS NOT ESTABLISHED

YES: bodily identity through change is grasped by intellect

YES: the essence of body is extension (WITHIN this Meditation)

YES: the mind is better known, in the sense of more indubitable

NO : that bodies EXIST - that is Meditation VI, by divine veracity

OPEN: whether knowledge of body is a priori

VERDICT: Meditation II already installs EXTENSION as body's essence, so the dualism "proved" in Meditation VI is in part PRESUPPOSED in Meditation II.
The Meditations must be read as ONE deductive arc, not six exercises.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/43: The three proofs of God and their division of labour

PROOF 1 - TRADEMARK / CAUSAL (Meditation III)

- 1 I have an idea of God: an infinite, perfect being.
- 2 The cause of an idea must have at least as much FORMAL reality as the idea has OBJECTIVE reality.
- 3 I, finite and imperfect, cannot be the adequate cause of an idea of an infinite perfect being.
- 4 THEREFORE God exists as its cause - He "stamped" the idea on my mind as a craftsman stamps his mark on his work.

ANSWERS: where could this idea have come from?

PROOF 2 - CONSERVATION / COSMOLOGICAL VARIANT (Meditation III)

I exist now; nothing in me gives me the power to sustain myself from one moment to the next; the cause of my continued existence must therefore ultimately be God.

ANSWERS: what keeps me in existence?

PROOF 3 - ONTOLOGICAL (Meditation V)

- 1 The concept of God = the concept of a supremely perfect being.
- 2 Existence is a perfection.
- 3 A supremely perfect being lacking existence would lack a perfection - a contradiction, like a triangle without three angles or a mountain without a valley.
- 4 THEREFORE God necessarily exists.

ANSWERS: what does the concept itself contain?

RIDER (one line only; Kant is Topic 04's owner): Kant objects that existence is not a real predicate.

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DIVINE VERACITY: A PERFECT BEING IS NO DECEIVER

+-----+-----+		
WHAT GOD SUPPLIES	WHAT COLLAPSES WITHOUT IT	
+-----+-----+		
general reliability of clear	nothing beyond the momentary thinking	
and distinct perception	self survives	
trustworthiness of memory and	the system contracts to isolated	
long chains of reasoning	intuitions; mathematics goes	
the guarantee behind natural	the external world remains unproved	
inclination		
continuous conservation of	"created substance" loses its ground	
finite substances		
+-----+-----+		

VERDICT LINE: the Meditations stand or fall on MEDITATION III, not Meditation II.

NAMING THE DIVISION OF LABOUR IS WORTH MORE THAN RECITING ALL THREE AT LENGTH.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/43: The Cartesian Circle: objection, reply and residual

THE OBJECTION (ARNAULD, FOURTH OBJECTIONS)

Descartes uses CLEAR AND DISTINCT PERCEPTION to prove that GOD exists;
he then uses GOD'S VERACITY to guarantee that CLEAR AND DISTINCT
PERCEPTION is reliable. The guarantee therefore presupposes what it is
meant to establish.

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criterion  ----- proves ----->  God
      ^                               |
      |                               |
      +----- certifies -----+

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THE PICTURE IN ONE LINE: Descartes builds a bridge out of God, and the planks
were cut from the far island he has not yet reached.

THE REPLY - TWO SITUATIONS MUST BE DISTINGUISHED

- (i) A clear and distinct perception ACTUALLY BEFORE THE MIND compels
assent and needs no external certificate. Some planks are solid enough
to stand on while you are looking at them.
- (ii) What needs certifying is the perception merely REMEMBERED as having
been clear, and any EXTENDED CHAIN of reasoning whose earlier steps
are no longer in view.

GOD SECURES CLASS (ii), NOT CLASS (i).

THE RESIDUAL - SAY THIS, OR THE ANSWER IS INCOMPLETE

The proofs of God are NOT single-flash intuitions. They are arguments with
premises, and by the time the conclusion is reached the earlier premises
are being REMEMBERED rather than attended to. So the memory reply SOFTENS
the objection without eliminating it.

COMPETING READINGS (optional depth, one clause at most)

vicious-circle reading (Arnauld's line) | memory-guarantee reading |
stronger anti-circle reading on which the cogito and simple intuitions are
self-certifying while attended to.

CONSEQUENCE FOR EVERY LATER PANEL: whatever divine veracity underwrites -
mathematics, memory, the external world, the conservation of created
substances - inherits this vulnerability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/43: The external world: Meditation VI in five steps

THE ARGUMENT [2019 Q1(d) is marked on these five steps]

- 1 SENSORY IDEAS ARRIVE INVOLUNTARILY. I cannot decide not to feel heat when near the fire. So I possess a PASSIVE FACULTY of receiving them.
- 2 A PASSIVE FACULTY REQUIRES AN ACTIVE CAUSE containing that reality formally or eminently.
- 3 THE CANDIDATES ARE: myself, God directly, or bodies. It is not myself, because the ideas arrive without my willing them.
- 4 I HAVE A GREAT NATURAL INCLINATION to refer them to bodies, and NO FACULTY by which God could have given me the means to correct it. If no bodies existed, God would be permitting an uncorrectable systematic error - that is, DECEIVING.
- 5 THEREFORE MATERIAL THINGS EXIST AS EXTENDED REALITIES.

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WHAT THE PROOF SECURES	WHAT IT DOES NOT SECURE
the existence of body	the literal accuracy of any particular
the reality of EXTENSION	colour, size, distance or sensible quality
	-> the senses are reliable for what is
	useful to the MIND-BODY UNION, not for
	metaphysics; INTELLECT must correct them

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EXCLUSION THAT IS ITSELF WORTH A MARK

THE WAX ARGUMENT DOES NOT DO THIS WORK. It shows HOW bodies would be known; it says nothing about whether any EXIST. Saying so explicitly separates a controlled answer from a confused one.

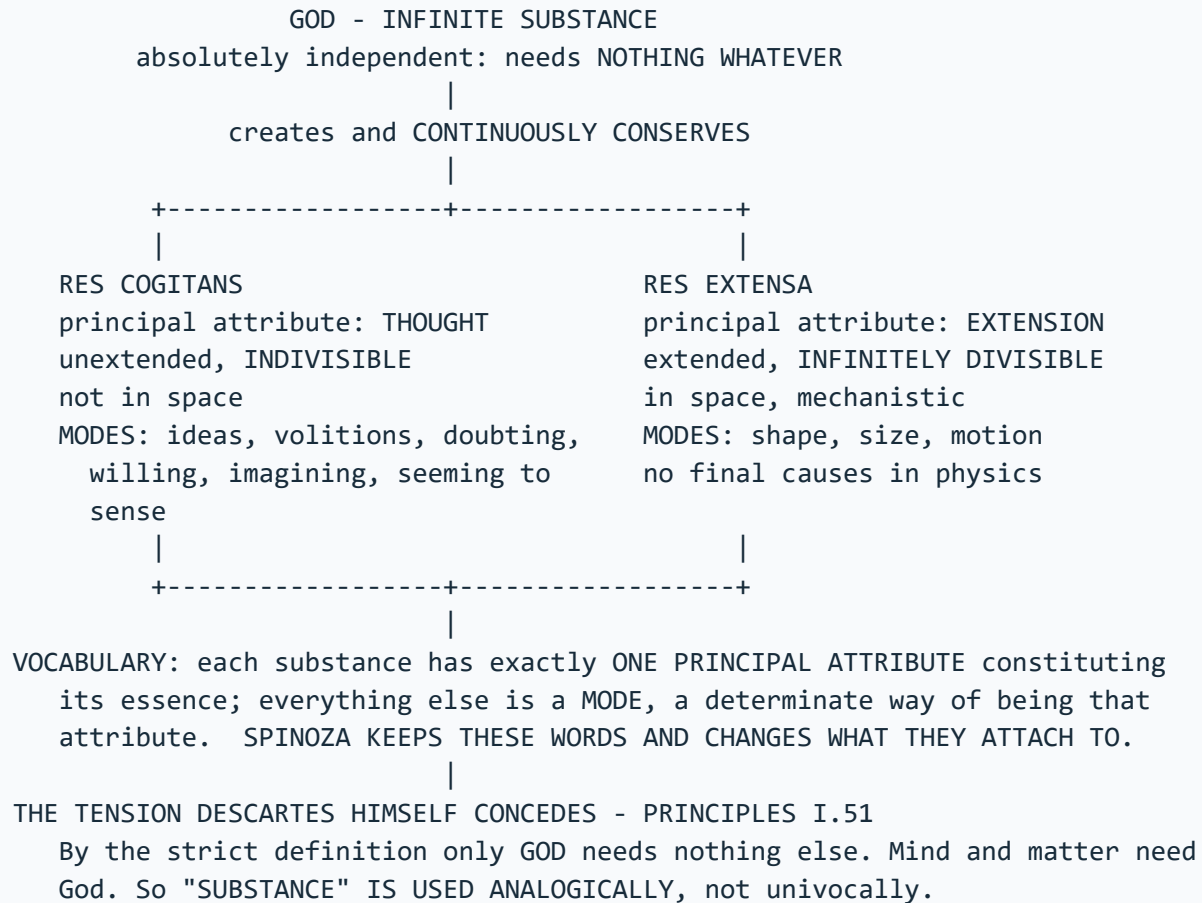
STRUCTURE OF THE PROOF: THEOLOGICAL, NOT PERCEPTUAL. What does the work is not the vividness of experience but the IMPOSSIBILITY OF DIVINE DECEPTION.

INHERITED VULNERABILITY: the whole bridge carries Arnould's Circle (Panel 12). The external world is only as secure as the divine proofs on which it rests.

ORDER TO MEMORISE: THINKING SELF -> GOD -> WORLD.

TRAP: "Descartes proved the external world first, then God" inverts the entire architecture.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/43: Descartes on substance and the real distinction



>>> THIS SINGLE CONCESSION IS THE HINGE OF 2018 Q2(a), AND IT IS WHAT
SPINOZA EXPLOITS. <<<

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THE ARGUMENT FOR REAL DISTINCTION (Meditation VI)

- 1 I clearly and distinctly conceive myself as a thinking, non-extended thing, and body as an extended, non-thinking thing.
- 2 Whatever I can clearly and distinctly conceive as separate, God is able to create as separate.
- 3 THEREFORE mind can exist without body, and body without mind.
- 4 THEREFORE they are REALLY DISTINCT - two substances, not two aspects.

CRITICAL NOTE: the whole argument rests on the CRITERION of Panel 6 and therefore on the DIVINE GUARANTEE of Panels 11-12. Dualism is a CONCLUSION of the system, never its starting assumption.

KNOWLEDGE ASYMMETRY [2022 Q4(b)]: the self is known IMMEDIATELY through the thinking act; the world only MEDIATELY, through ideas whose reliability depends on God's veracity being established first.

THE PROBLEM

RES COGITANS and RES EXTENSA SHARE NOTHING WHATEVER.

And yet, in a human being: a decision to raise the arm -> the arm rises;
a pin in the foot -> a FELT pain, not an observed injury.

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PRINCESS ELISABETH OF BOHEMIA, correspondence of 1643:

HOW can a thing whose entire nature is THOUGHT determine the animal spirits
to move the body, when causation of motion seems to require contact and
extension? Causation appears to require some COMMUNITY between cause and
effect; thought and extension have NONE.

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DESCARTES' TWO ANSWERS - KEEP THEM APART

PHYSIOLOGICAL: the PINEAL GLAND (Passions of the Soul), chosen because it
is a single UNPAIRED structure at the centre of the brain, whereas most
brain structures are duplicated.

>>> THIS IS A LOCATION, NOT A MECHANISM. <<<

PHILOSOPHICAL: the mind-body UNION is a THIRD PRIMITIVE NOTION, alongside
thought and extension, grasped through ORDINARY LIVING rather than
through pure intellect. Trying to conceive it by intellect alone is
precisely what makes it seem impossible.

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VERDICT: the reply PRESERVES THE PHENOMENON and ABANDONS THE MECHANISM.

THIS VACANCY IS WHAT SPINOZA AND LEIBNIZ COMPETE TO FILL.

The union is intimate, NOT a pilot in a ship - which is why we FEEL pain.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/43: Interaction, the union, error and Cartesian freedom (continued)

ERROR AND FREEDOM (MEDITATION IV)

THE WILL is INFINITE in scope: I can affirm or deny anything whatever.

THE INTELLECT is FINITE: I perceive clearly only within limits.

ERROR = the will affirming BEYOND what the intellect clearly perceives.

-> error is not caused by God but by my misuse of a perfect faculty

FREEDOM includes the power to AFFIRM, DENY or WITHHOLD ASSENT, and is not reducible to bodily mechanism.

GRADES: MERE INDIFFERENCE IS THE LOWEST GRADE OF FREEDOM. When the intellect clearly perceives truth, the will assents MORE freely, because it is moved by evident reason rather than by ignorance or compulsion.

TRAP: the claim that indifference is the highest freedom REVERSES the text.

OPEN QUESTION: Descartes is usually classed a libertarian, but the relation between alternative possibilities, clear intellectual determination and divine preordination is contested and underexplained.

TRAP: "the ghost in the machine" is GILBERT RYLE'S hostile coinage, The Concept of Mind, 1949 - NEVER Descartes' own phrase.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 22/43: Spinoza: one substance and its architecture

THE ARGUMENT FOR MONISM (Ethics I, more geometrico)

- 1 DEFINITION. Substance = what is IN ITSELF and is CONCEIVED THROUGH ITSELF; its concept requires no other concept.
- 2 NO SHARING. Two substances cannot share an attribute - if they did there would be nothing left by which to tell them apart QUA SUBSTANCE.
- 3 NO FINITUDE. A finite substance would have to be limited by another OF THE SAME NATURE - which step 2 forbids. So substance is necessarily INFINITE.
- 4 CONCLUSION. There can be only ONE substance, and it must possess ALL attributes: ABSOLUTELY INFINITE. This is God.

COROLLARY: being in itself and conceived through itself, substance is SELF-CAUSED (causa sui): its essence involves existence.

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+-----+
| ONE ABSOLUTELY INFINITE, SELF-CAUSED SUBSTANCE = DEUS SIVE NATURA |
+-----+
|
INFINITELY MANY ATTRIBUTES, each expressing the WHOLE eternal and infinite
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 23/43: Spinoza: one substance and its architecture (continued)

essence of substance - NOT a portion of it, NOT a part, NOT a substance

+-----+-----+-----+		
THOUGHT (known to us)	EXTENSION (known)	infinitely many
		further attributes
INFINITE MODES	INFINITE MODES	unknown to us
the infinite	motion-and-rest	
intellect		
FINITE MODES	FINITE MODES	
my mind, your mind	my body, this stone	
+-----+-----+-----+		

THE SAME ORDER, TWICE OVER (Ethics II, P7) - see Panel 20

↓
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MODE = an affection of substance; that which is IN ANOTHER and is CONCEIVED THROUGH ANOTHER. Ethics I, P15: "WHATEVER IS, IS IN GOD, and nothing can be or be conceived without God." The "IN" is ONTOLOGICAL, NOT SPATIAL.

TWO GRADES OF MODE: INFINITE modes follow immediately or mediately from the absolute nature of an attribute; FINITE modes are determined by other finite modes in an endless series.

TRAP: confusing Spinoza's ATTRIBUTES with Descartes' SUBSTANCES destroys every comparative answer, because it removes the reason parallelism replaces interaction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 24/43: Spinoza's God: immanence and the three labels

WHAT THIS GOD IS

NOT a person; does NOT choose; does NOT deliberate; has NO purpose and NO providence. God acts from the NECESSITY OF THE DIVINE NATURE.

Ethics I, P18: GOD IS THE IMMANENT, NOT THE TRANSITIVE, CAUSE OF ALL THINGS

TRANSITIVE cause produces something OUTSIDE itself - a carpenter and a table

IMMANENT cause REMAINS IN ITS EFFECT - the sea and the wave

NATURA NATURANS = substance and its attributes as FREE ACTIVE CAUSE

NATURA NATURATA = the totality of MODES that follows from that necessity

DEUS SIVE NATURA = "God, or Nature" - Ethics IV, Preface, and IV, P4 Dem.

Safe to quote verbatim in Latin.

NOT AN ATHEIST: excommunicated in 1656 for HETERODOXY, not atheism; the position is unorthodox theism or pantheism in which God is INDISPENSABLE.

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DOES THE DOCTRINE OF SUBSTANCE LEAD TO PANTHEISM? [2022 Q2(c) - TAKE A SIDE]

+-----+		
WHAT IS ESTABLISHED	nothing exists outside God; all finite things are	
	modes existing in and conceived through God; God is	
	the immanent cause -> IN THAT PRECISE SENSE, YES	
WHAT IS NOT	it does NOT follow that any finite thing, or the	
ESTABLISHED	visible aggregate, is numerically identical with	
	the whole infinite divine essence; substance	
	EXCEEDS the two attributes we know	
THE RIVAL LABEL	PANENTHEISM - all things are IN God while God	
	exceeds them; interpreters genuinely dispute which	
	label is more accurate	
THE OPPOSITE CHARGE	ACOSMISM (Hegel): if only substance is real, the	
	finite world DISSOLVES INTO NOTHING - Spinoza is	
	accused not of deifying the world but of DENYING it	
THE REPLY	modes are real AS EXPRESSIONS, with dependent	
	rather than independent reality; "not	
	self-subsistent" is not "not real"	
DEFENDED VERDICT	a QUALIFIED PANTHEIST: divine immanence is	
	undeniable; divine infinity blocks reduction to the	
	world we perceive	
+-----+		

TRAP: pantheism and acosmism are OPPOSITE accusations. Treating them as one objection makes the 2022 answer incoherent.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 25/43: Spinoza: necessitarianism and the denial of contingency

THE PROPOSITIONS THAT CARRY THE DOCTRINE

- I, P16 From the necessity of the divine nature there must follow
INFINITELY MANY THINGS in INFINITELY MANY WAYS.
[2020 Q4(b) quotes exactly this]
- I, P29 NOTHING IN NATURE IS CONTINGENT; all is determined by the necessity
of the divine nature to exist and act in a certain way.
- I, P33 Things could have been produced in NO OTHER WAY and in NO OTHER
ORDER.
- I, Def.7 That thing is FREE which exists solely from the necessity of ITS
OWN NATURE and is determined to action BY ITSELF ALONE.

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THE DERIVATION [2019 Q2(c): "what is, cannot be other than what it is"]

- 1 God, or Nature, is the one self-caused substance, acting from the
necessity of the divine nature alone.
- 2 P16: infinitely many things follow from that necessity - modes follow
from WHAT SUBSTANCE IS, as conclusions follow from premises.
- 3 THEREFORE modes are not products of a discretionary decree; there is no
deliberation, no selection among alternatives, no purpose.
- 4 P29: contingency is a name for OUR IGNORANCE OF CAUSES, not an objective
gap in the order.
- 5 Finite modes are determined by OTHER FINITE MODES in an endless series
WITHIN the one necessary order.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 26/43: Spinoza: necessitarianism and the denial of contingency (continued)

THREE DISTINCTIONS THAT MUST STAY CLEAN

- (i) God is free NOT because God could have chosen otherwise but because God is determined by NOTHING EXTERNAL (Def. 7).
- (ii) The necessity is LOGICAL-ONTOLOGICAL, not fatalistic compulsion by an external agent. There is no agent doing the pushing.
- (iii) Denying contingency is NOT denying causality; it is denying that the causal order could have run differently.

ALSO: the inference is ONTOLOGICAL, NOT TEMPORAL. It is not a story in which God exists first and produces a world afterwards.

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THREE CRITICISMS OF P16, WITH REPLIES AND RESIDUES

necessity removes divine PERSONALITY -> will and intellect are not faculties outside nature; anthropomorphic choice would LIMIT God
RESIDUAL: providence, petition and worship are genuinely lost

EVIL follows necessarily from God -> good and evil express relations to human flourishing, not properties of infinite substance

RESIDUAL: suffering still belongs, unredeemed, to the necessary order

P16 ASSERTS MORE THAN THE DEFINITIONS PROVE -> an infinite cause must express itself infinitely

RESIDUAL: the derivation of DETERMINATE FINITE modes remains the hardest step in Ethics I

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 27/43: Spinoza: 'determination is negation' - provenance and use

PROVENANCE FIRST - THIS LINE IS ITSELF WORTH A MARK [2025 Q2(b)]

The exact Latin formula OMNIS DETERMINATIO EST NEGATIO IS NOT IN THE ETHICS.

Spinoza writes DETERMINATIO NEGATIO EST in LETTER 50 TO JARIG JELLES, 2 JUNE 1674.

The universalised slogan is HEGEL'S rendering, and that is how it entered the textbook tradition.

SAFE SENTENCE: "Spinoza's dictum, in Letter 50, that determination is negation - universalised by Hegel as omnis determinatio est negatio."

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THE MEANING

To DETERMINE something is to make it definite, finite, BOUNDED.

To say a thing is THIS is to say it is NOT everything else.

FINITUDE THEREFORE CONTAINS NEGATION.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 28/43: Spinoza: 'determination is negation' - provenance and use (continued)

THREE CONSEQUENCES - EXACTLY WHAT A "COMMENT" ANSWER NEEDS

FOR GOD	absolutely infinite, bounded by nothing external, so God involves NO negation whatever: PURE AFFIRMATION, undetermined by anything outside
FOR FINITE MODES	each is limited by OTHER MODES OF THE SAME NATURE - a body occupies this region and excludes others; an idea expresses only a bounded causal perspective; their determinacy marks DEPENDENCE
FOR KNOWLEDGE AND FREEDOM	inadequate knowledge treats a finite thing IN ISOLATION; adequate knowledge understands it THROUGH THE AFFIRMATIVE WHOLE, seeing it SUB SPECIE AETERNITATIS - under the aspect of eternity

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HEGEL'S CRITICISM AND THE REPLY

CRITICISM: if determination is negation, the finite becomes MERE negation, and the world vanishes into substance -> ACOSMISM.

REPLY: what is negated is INDEPENDENT SELF-SUBSISTENCE, not reality as such; modes POSITIVELY EXPRESS divine power in determinate ways.

VERDICT: the dictum illuminates why finite beings are dependent, but it becomes reductive if LIMITATION is mistaken for UNREALITY. Spinoza needs BOTH the negation of independence AND the affirmation of modal expression.

DIRECTIVE NOTE: "COMMENT" means short, pointed and THESIS-FIRST, stating what the sentence means INSIDE Spinoza's own system - never a general essay.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 29/43: Spinoza: parallelism dissolves the mind-body problem

THE PROPOSITIONS

II, P7 The ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS is the same as the ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS.

II, P13 The human MIND IS THE IDEA OF THE HUMAN BODY - so the mind's adequacy tracks the body's power of acting.

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THE PICTURE

IDEA_1	----->	IDEA_2	----->	IDEA_3	causation stays INSIDE Thought
					the SAME modes, the SAME order
BODY_1	----->	BODY_2	----->	BODY_3	causation stays INSIDE Extension

>>> THERE ARE NO ARROWS BETWEEN THE ROWS. THAT IS THE WHOLE DOCTRINE. <<<

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 30/43: Spinoza: parallelism dissolves the mind-body problem (continued)

A decision to raise the arm and the arm's movement are ONE AND THE SAME MODE, expressed under Thought and under Extension respectively.

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THE DISSOLUTION

The mind-body problem was GENERATED by Descartes' assumption that mind and body are DIFFERENT SUBSTANCES. Remove the assumption and the problem does not get SOLVED - it stops ARISING. Spinoza does not build a bridge; he denies there is a gap.

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THE COST - STATE IT HONESTLY

If no idea can cause a bodily motion, ORDINARY MENTAL CAUSATION disappears. Thought and Extension are each CAUSALLY CLOSED, so critics say the correspondence is secured at the price of making mind explanatorily idle. SPINOZA'S ANSWER: the mind is not idle WITHIN Thought - an adequate idea genuinely causes further adequate ideas - but the ordinary intuition that a decision moves a limb is indeed abandoned.

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TRAPS

"two parallel trains running alongside" quietly RESTORES two things.

Spinoza's claim is stronger: ONE thing, described completely TWICE.

"God continually adjusts the two series" is OCCASIONALISM, a rival seventeenth-century position that Spinoza's monism makes unnecessary. Making II, P13 a CAUSAL claim ("the body produces the mind") reinstates exactly the cross-attribute causation the doctrine excludes.

POSITION IN THE 2024 RANKING: metaphysically the most ECONOMICAL account, and the one that most decisively removes the problem - at the price of necessitarianism and the loss of free will.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 31/43: Spinoza: three kinds of knowledge and freedom

THE THREE KINDS (Ethics II, P40, Scholium 2)

KIND	NAME	SOURCE	ADEQUACY
FIRST	imaginatio / opinio	(a) EXPERIENTIA VAGA - random experience through the senses (b) EX SIGNIS - hearsay, words, memory	INADEQUATE, mutilated and confused II, P41: THE ONLY CAUSE OF FALSITY
SECOND	ratio	COMMON NOTIONS (notiones communes) - what is EQUALLY IN THE PART AND IN THE WHOLE	ADEQUATE, necessarily true (II, P41)
THIRD	scientia intuitiva	from an adequate idea of the formal essence of certain ATTRIBUTES OF GOD to adequate knowledge of the ESSENCE of things	ADEQUATE, and grasped IN ONE ACT; the highest (V, P25)

SPINOZA'S OWN EXAMPLE - THE FOURTH PROPORTIONAL (1 : 2 :: 3 : ?) = 6

MERCHANT multiplies the second by the third and divides by the first, because he was taught the rule or has seen it work -> FIRST

MATHEMATICIAN demonstrates it from the common property of proportionals (Euclid VII.19); adequate but DISCURSIVE -> SECOND

ANYONE, HERE sees AT A GLANCE that the fourth is 6, grasping the ratio in the essences themselves, IN ONE ACT -> THIRD

THE THIRD KIND IS SCIENTIA INTUITIVA - name it in full, never just "intuition". MNEMONIC "M-M-S": Merchant, Mathematician, Seer.

THE THREE KINDS ARE THREE ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS OF THE KNOWER, NOT THREE DEGREES OF CONFIDENCE.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 32/43: Spinoza: three kinds of knowledge and freedom (continued)

THE ARGUMENT THAT MAKES KNOWLEDGE INTO FREEDOM

- 1 Everything follows necessarily from the nature of God or Substance.
- 2 An idea is ADEQUATE when understood through its cause - through its place in that necessary order.
- 3 BONDAGE (servitus) = being determined by causes EXTERNAL to my nature, which is exactly the condition of one whose ideas are inadequate, since inadequate ideas are the TRACES OF OTHER BODIES in mine.
- 4 FREEDOM (I, Def. 7) = being determined by MY OWN nature alone.
- 5 Adequate ideas ARE the mind acting from its own nature, for in having them the mind is the ADEQUATE CAUSE of what follows from them.
- 6 THEREFORE moving from the first kind to the second and third IS moving from bondage to freedom. KNOWLEDGE IS NOT A MEANS TO FREEDOM; IT IS FREEDOM.
- 7 At the limit the third kind sees things SUB SPECIE AETERNITATIS and generates the INTELLECTUAL LOVE OF GOD (amor Dei intellectualis, V, P32 Cor.) - the mind's highest good and blessedness (beatitudo).

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STRIVING AND THE AFFECTS - RETAINED ONLY AS FAR AS THEY EXPLAIN FREEDOM

III, P6-P7 each thing strives to persevere in its being (CONATUS), and this striving IS THE ACTUAL ESSENCE of the thing. In a human being, conscious striving appears as DESIRE.

PASSIVE AFFECTS arise when the person is only a PARTIAL cause under external determination. ACTIVE AFFECTS arise from adequate ideas and register an INCREASE IN THE POWER OF ACTING.

FREE WILL IS AN ILLUSION: we are conscious of our DESIRES but ignorant of the CAUSES that determine them - a thrown STONE, if conscious, would believe it chose to fly.

ONLY GOD IS ABSOLUTELY FREE. Human freedom is RELATIVE and ACHIEVED.

LIVE WEAKNESS TO CONCEDE: II, P43 - "he who has a true idea knows at the same time that he has a true idea"; truth is the standard of itself and of the false (verum index sui). But SELF-CERTIFICATION is exactly what confident IMAGINATION also feels like.

CONCEDE ALSO: alternative possibilities never return, and even the achievement of freedom is itself necessitated.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 33/43: Leibniz: monads, hierarchy and indiscernibles

THE ARGUMENT TO SIMPLES (Monadology Sec.1-3)

- 1 Extension is essentially DIVISIBLE.
- 2 Whatever is divisible is a COMPOSITE, an aggregate of parts.
- 3 An aggregate derives its reality from the reality of its constituents;
a heap of heaps of heaps, with no grains anywhere, is no heap.
- 4 THEREFORE extended things cannot be ultimate. There must be SIMPLE
substances, and these cannot themselves be extended.

NOTE: this refutes SPINOZA too - if extension cannot be a possible essence
of substance, Extension cannot be an attribute in Spinoza's sense.

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A PARTLESS UNIT HAS NO SHAPE, NO SIZE, NO POSITION. WHAT INNER STATES
REMAIN? Only REPRESENTING and PASSING FROM ONE REPRESENTATION TO THE NEXT.

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GOD

the unique UNCREATED necessary simple substance; source of all
monads; complete and infinite intelligence

CAUTION: "the supreme Monad" is common SHORTHAND - God is NOT merely
the top member of the CREATED series

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+-----+-----+-----+		
RATIONAL SPIRITS	ANIMAL SOULS	BARE MONADS
(minds)	(souls proper)	(bare entelechies)
APPERCEPTION - conscious	MEMORY, producing a	only obscure and
reflexive awareness;	"consecutiveness"	confused MINUTE
grasp of NECESSARY and	resembling reason;	PERCEPTIONS
ETERNAL TRUTHS; science	perception raised to	(petites
and morality; moral	distinct feeling	perceptions); no
community with God		apperception
+-----+-----+-----+		

EVERY monad at EVERY level has PERCEPTION and APPETITION.

PERCEPTION = the representation of the manifold in the simple.

IT DOES NOT IMPLY CONSCIOUSNESS.

APPETITION = the internal principle producing change; the tendency
carrying one perception into the next.

PETITES PERCEPTIONS = perceptions below reflective awareness. Leibniz's

illustration: the ROAR OF THE SEA - we hear the whole
roar, so we must in some way perceive each wave.

APPERCEPTION = conscious reflexive awareness. TRAP: it must NOT be
attributed to every monad.

Each monad represents the WHOLE universe from its own point of view - "a
perpetual living mirror of the universe".

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TWO DOCTRINES THAT MAKE THIS WORK

NO WINDOWS (Monadology Sec.7): "Monads have no windows through which
anything could come in or go out" - as it is USUALLY RENDERED; the
French is Les Monades n'ont point de fenetres. No causal influx enters;
all change arises INTERNALLY from appetite.

IDENTITY OF INDISCERNIBLES: no two monads are exactly alike, because God
would have had NO SUFFICIENT REASON to create both rather than one.

-> INDIVIDUALITY IS GUARANTEED, NOT MERELY PERMITTED. This is precisely
what Spinoza's system cannot deliver, and it is Leibniz's motive.

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AND WHAT ABOUT BODIES?

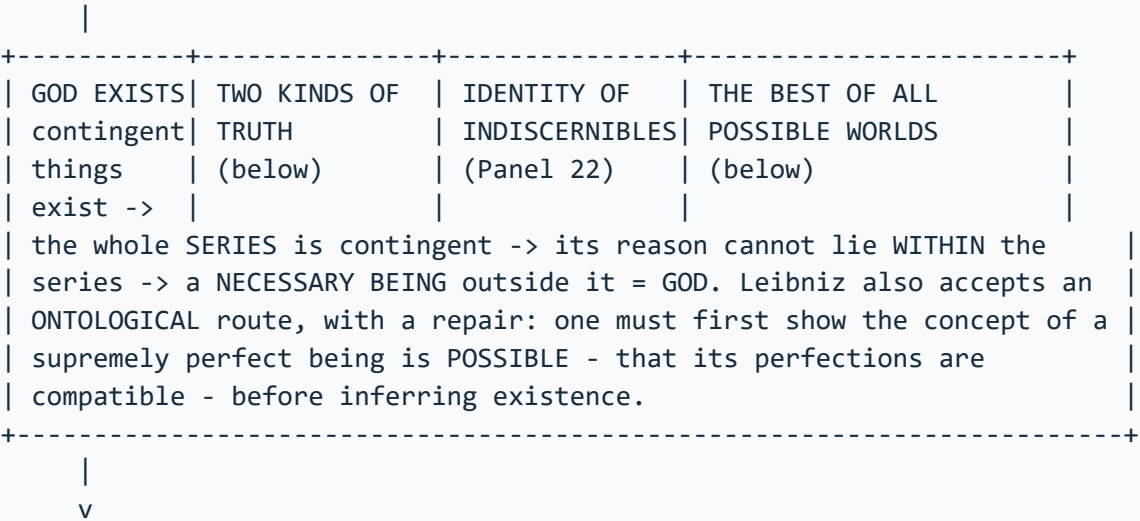
An organism is coordinated by a DOMINANT MONAD together with an ORGANIC
AGGREGATE of subordinate monads - coordination, NOT causal control through
exchanged signals.

Extended bodies are WELL-FOUNDED PHENOMENA (phaenomena bene fundata),
grounded in ordered monadic aggregates: NOT ultimate substances, but
NEITHER arbitrary private illusions. The adjective "WELL-FOUNDED" is doing
the work; dropping it turns Leibniz into a subjective idealist, which he is
not.

CONSEQUENCE: interaction is impossible IN PRINCIPLE, so the mind-body question
must be answered some other way - see Panel 23.

PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON (PSR)

"Nothing is without a reason why it is so rather than otherwise."



	TRUTHS OF REASON	TRUTHS OF FACT
Example	a triangle has three sides;	Caesar crossed the
	mathematics and logic	Rubicon
Opposite	implies a CONTRADICTION	is CONCEIVABLE
Modality	NECESSARY	CONTINGENT, yet certain
Governed by	principle of contradiction	the PSR
Analysis	FINITE - reducible to	INFINITE - completed
	identities	only by GOD

COMPLETE INDIVIDUAL CONCEPT: every predicate ever true of an individual

belongs to its concept, which God grasps entirely.

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>>> SO IS EVERYTHING NECESSARY? NO - AND THIS IS WHERE THE MARKS ARE <<<

ABSOLUTE / LOGICAL NECESSITY opposite implies a contradiction -> TRUTHS
OF REASON ONLY

HYPOTHETICAL / MORAL NECESSITY given God's choice of the best, the series
follows CERTAINLY - but its opposite remains
LOGICALLY CONCEIVABLE in another possible
world

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POSSIBLE WORLDS AND THE BEST WORLD

God's understanding contains infinitely many possible individuals. Not all
possibles are COMPOSSIBLE - capable of existing together - so a possible
world is a MAXIMAL COMPOSSIBLE SET.

God actualises the world of GREATEST PERFECTION = THE GREATEST VARIETY OF
PHENOMENA GOVERNED BY THE SIMPLEST LAWS. "Best" does NOT mean maximum human
comfort or the absence of suffering.

THEODICY, as far as this topic owns it: evil is permitted because a world
containing it is, overall, the most perfect compossible WHOLE; perfection is
a property of the SYSTEM, not of each part alone.

VOLTAIRE, CANDIDE (1759): satire and RECEPTION, never doctrine.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 37/43: Leibniz: sufficient reason, worlds, harmony, freedom (continued 2)

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY - LEIBNIZ'S OWN THREE OPTIONS

- 1 INFLUENCE a rod between the two clocks = DESCARTES' interaction
 -> rejected as unintelligible
- 2 ASSISTANCE a keeper adjusting them at = OCCASIONALISM
 every moment -> rejected as unworthy of a
 perfect craftsman
- 3 HARMONY perfect construction AT THE = LEIBNIZ
 OUTSET, so both keep the same
 time with no connection

TRAP: describing harmony as continuous divine intervention converts Leibniz into an occasionalist. It is set ONCE, AT CREATION.

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FREEDOM = THREE CONDITIONS, JOINTLY NECESSARY

- SPONTANEITY the action springs from the agent's own nature; no external
 compulsion - GUARANTEED BY WINDOWLESSNESS ITSELF
- INTELLIGENCE the agent deliberates and acts for perceived reasons, not by
 blind impact - this distinguishes a rational spirit from a
 bare monad
- CONTINGENCY the actual world is one of infinitely many possible worlds;
 the opposite of the act implies no contradiction

MECHANISM: reasons INCLINE WITHOUT NECESSITATING

(incliner sans necessiter) - the determination is MORAL, not LOGICAL.

RESIDUAL TO CONCEDE: since the complete concept of the ACTUAL agent is fixed and this world is actualised, alternatives lie ACROSS worlds, not WITHIN this one; a libertarian will call that contingency merely epistemic.

VERDICT: COHERENT COMPATIBILISM, NOT INDETERMINISTIC FREEDOM.

TRAPS: not a libertarian | not a fatalist | not an occasionalist | Candide is satire | spontaneity ALONE is not the doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 38/43: Seven-axis comparison and the criticism ledger

THE SEVEN AXES THAT COVER EVERY COMPARATIVE QUESTION IN THIS TOPIC

AXIS	DESCARTES	SPINOZA	LEIBNIZ
substance	3: God, mind, matter	1: God, or Nature	infinitely many monads
God	personal, transcendent; veracity-guarantee	impersonal, immanent; IS all reality	necessary being; chose the best possible world
mind-body	INTERACTION (pineal gland)	PARALLELISM (double aspect)	PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY
freedom	libertarian free will	freedom = understanding necessity	compatibilism
method	doubt -> cogito -> reconstruction	geometrical demonstration	sufficient reason + complete concepts
the individual	a thinking SUBSTANCE	a MODE of God	a unique MONAD - a substance
the physical world	res extensa, mechanistic	a mode of the attribute Extension	WELL-FOUNDED PHENOMENON

READ ACROSS THE ROWS, NOT DOWN THE COLUMNS. The examiner almost always asks you to read across.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 39/43: Seven-axis comparison and the criticism ledger (continued)

CRITICISM -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL (the third column is where marks are earned)

DESCARTES

the Circle (Arnauld) -> attended intuition vs remembered certainty ->

RESIDUAL: the divine proofs themselves use remembered premises

interaction gap (Elisabeth, 1643) -> the union is a PRIMITIVE NOTION ->

RESIDUAL: a location, not a mechanism

"substance" is equivocal -> analogical: absolute of God, relative of creatures -> RESIDUAL: Spinoza exploits exactly this concession

SPINOZA

pantheism removes a personal God -> morality rests on adequate knowledge, not divine command -> RESIDUAL: providence and petition are lost

ACOSMISM (Hegel) -> modes are real AS EXPRESSIONS ->

RESIDUAL: dependent individuality remains thin

determinism ends responsibility -> responsibility is reinterpreted; the free person acts from understanding -> RESIDUAL: alternatives never return

"determination is negation" makes the finite merely negative -> finite things are POSITIVE modes limited by other modes -> RESIDUAL: the slogan is Hegel's universalisation of Letter 50

LEIBNIZ

harmony is ad hoc and unfalsifiable -> the only route avoiding both unintelligible influx and monism, and requiring no continuous miracle -> RESIDUAL: the defence is comparative, not positive

"best of all possible worlds" (Voltaire) -> "best" = maximum variety under simplest laws -> RESIDUAL: the perfection criterion is not independently testable

fixed complete concepts erase freedom -> the opposite implies no contradiction -> RESIDUAL: alternatives lie across worlds, not within this one

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RANKING REQUIRES A DECLARED CRITERION

freedom = ALTERNATIVE POSSIBILITIES -> DESCARTES, at the price of an unintelligible interaction

freedom = SELF-DETERMINATION -> SPINOZA, at the price of free will altogether

freedom = RESPONSIBLE AGENCY UNDER SYSTEMATIC DETERMINATION -> LEIBNIZ [2024 safe verdict]

mind-body by EXPLANATORY ECONOMY -> Spinoza | by FIDELITY TO EXPERIENCE -> Descartes | by SYSTEMATIC CONSISTENCY -> Leibniz

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 40/43: PYQ routes, directives, spine and the conclusion

EXACT PYQ ROUTE MAP, 2018-2025 - FOURTEEN PRIMARY-OWNED PARTS

- 2018 Q1(b) 10m harmony -> windowlessness -> spontaneity + intelligence + contingency -> hypothetical necessity -> verdict
- 2018 Q2(a) 20m shared definition -> three enforcements -> costs -> "substance is a criterion, not a discovery"
- 2019 Q1(d) 10m five-step Meditation VI causal argument -> limits -> theological dependence
- 2019 Q2(c) 15m P16 -> three distinctions -> ethical consequence -> responsibility objection
- 2020 Q1(b) 10m monadic structure -> determination -> three conditions -> SIGNPOSTED FIRST-PERSON PARAGRAPH
- 2020 Q4(b) 15m P16 + P18 -> four consequences -> three criticisms with replies
- 2022 Q2(c) 15m four-step monism -> attributes and modes -> DECLARED pantheism verdict -> acosmism
- 2022 Q4(b) 15m doubt -> cogito -> res cogitans -> mediated world -> certainty vs substantiality
- 2023 Q1(c) 10m interpret Def. 7 -> stone analogy -> adequate causation -> concession
- 2023 Q2(c) 15m three kinds of ideas -> insufficiency -> DISPOSITIONAL innateness -> Locke's two tests -> adjudication
- 2024 Q2(b) 15m substance argument -> ontological "in" -> P18 -> three objections and replies
- 2024 Q3(c) 15m ANNOUNCE CRITERION -> all three accounts -> ranked verdict -> the winner's cost
- 2025 Q2(a) 20m five tenets -> seven Cartesian stages -> unifying logic -> four vulnerabilities
- 2025 Q2(b) 15m LETTER 50 PROVENANCE -> meaning -> God, modes, knowledge -> acosmism -> ruling

SOURCE NOTE: the 2019, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 Paper I wordings were read from the official papers held locally; the 2018 and 2020 Paper I papers are NOT in the repository, so those two follow the verified PYQ ledger.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 41/43: PYQ routes, directives, spine and the conclusion (continued)

DIRECTIVE DECODER

DISCUSS	exposition + assessment, roughly 60:40
CRITICALLY DISCUSS/EXAMINE	assessment DOMINATES; a verdict is compulsory
COMMENT	short, pointed, thesis-first, inside the author's own system
EXPLAIN	foreground the DERIVATION, not a paraphrase
SUBSTANTIATE YOUR VIEW	take a side and defend it with textual grounds
WITH YOUR OWN COMMENTS	a signposted FIRST-PERSON final quarter
"WHOSE ACCOUNT ...?"	rank all three against a stated criterion and DEFEND the ranking
"WHAT IS THE REASON ...?"	give a MECHANISM, not a table

ANSWER SPINES AND LENGTH BANDS

10 MARKS	D-R-A-E	Define -> Reconstruct -> Apply a named text -> Evaluate about 150-200 words
15 MARKS	D-R-D-E-V	Define -> Reconstruct -> Debate -> Evaluate -> Verdict about 250-300 words
20 MARKS	C-M-C	Common premise -> Mechanism of divergence -> Comparative costs and conclusion about 340-400 words
PARAGRAPH CONTROL: CLAIM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION.		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 42/43: PYQ routes, directives, spine and the conclusion (continued 2)

PROVENANCE AND CITATION DISCIPLINE

Cite Spinoza STRUCTURALLY (I, Def. 7; I, P15; I, P16; I, P18; I, P29;
II, P7; II, P13; II, P40 Sch. 2; V, P32 Cor.) - translation-invariant.
"Determination is negation" = LETTER 50, 2 June 1674; universalised by
HEGEL. NOT a sentence of the Ethics.
"The ghost in the machine" = GILBERT RYLE, The Concept of Mind, 1949.
NOT Descartes.
CANDIDE (1759) = VOLTAIRE'S SATIRE. NOT Leibniz's doctrine.
"Monads have no windows" and "incline without necessitating" are STANDARD
RENDERINGS - say so.
"cogito, ergo sum" is from the DISCOURSE and PRINCIPLES I.7, not the
Meditations.
inspectio mentis = "purely mental scrutiny" (Cottingham-Stoothoff-Murdoch)
or "inspection of the mind" (Haldane-Ross) - name the edition or
paraphrase.

FINAL TRAP SHEET - TEN LINES

- 1 The cogito is not a syllogism and does not by itself prove a soul.
- 2 The wax argument does not prove that bodies exist.
- 3 Descartes' "substance" is ANALOGICAL - Principles I.51.
- 4 Thought and Extension are Spinozist ATTRIBUTES, not substances.
- 5 Spinoza's freedom is not indeterminism, and Spinoza is not an atheist.
- 6 Pantheism and acosmism are OPPOSITE charges.
- 7 Monads never interact, and not every monad apperceives.
- 8 Harmony is set ONCE at creation; continuous adjustment is occasionalism.
- 9 Leibnizian certainty is NOT absolute necessity.
- 10 A comparative answer without a declared CRITERION stays descriptive.

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

All three men accept that reason can reach a necessary intelligible order, and all three inherit ONE definition of substance. The differences are produced by how strictly that definition is enforced: loosely, giving three substances and an interaction Descartes cannot explain; strictly, giving one substance and a world in which individuality and alternatives are lost; strictly plus simplicity, giving infinitely many substances whose agreement must be arranged by God in advance.

Judged by EXPLANATORY ECONOMY Spinoza wins; by FIDELITY TO EXPERIENCE Descartes wins; by SYSTEMATIC CONSISTENCY Leibniz wins.

THAT NO SINGLE CRITERION SELECTS ONE ANSWER IS ITSELF THE STRONGEST EVIDENCE THAT WHAT DESCARTES BEQUEATHED WAS A PSEUDO-PROBLEM RATHER THAN A PROBLEM - AND IT IS WHY THE NEXT SYLLABUS ITEM, EMPIRICISM, BEGINS BY ATTACKING THE INNATE RESOURCES ON WHICH THE WHOLE PROGRAMME RESTS.